

Use the queen without losing time

Foundations

THE IDEA

The queen combines rook and bishop movement but is too valuable to expose casually. Early queen adventures let cheaper pieces attack her while developing. A queen move earns its place when it creates a concrete threat, wins material, or supports a necessary defense.

WORKED EXAMPLE

In 1.e4 e5 2.Qh5 Nc6, Black develops and defends e5. White must still bring out minor pieces and secure the king. A threat against f7 does not automatically justify repeating queen moves while the rest of the army sleeps.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Is every early queen move a mistake?

ANSWER AND REASONING

No. Some are sound theory or concrete tactics. The useful question is whether the queen can be attacked with gain of time and whether your undeveloped pieces can join the action.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Judge queen activity together with development and safety.